CATHARSIS

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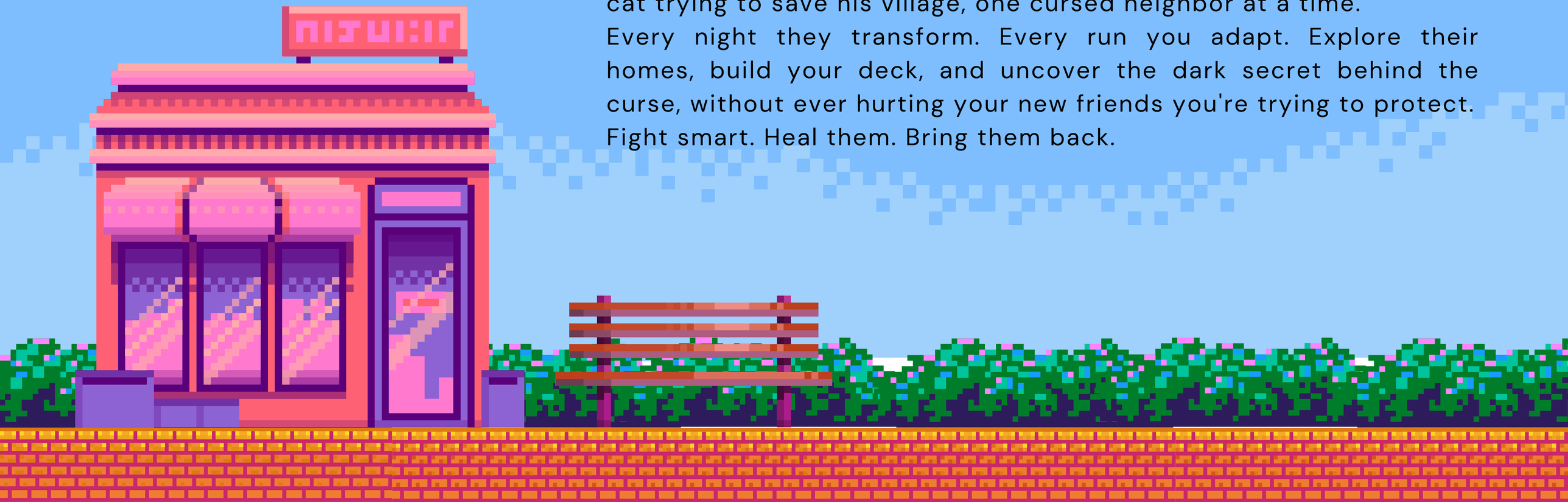
ELEVATOR PITCH

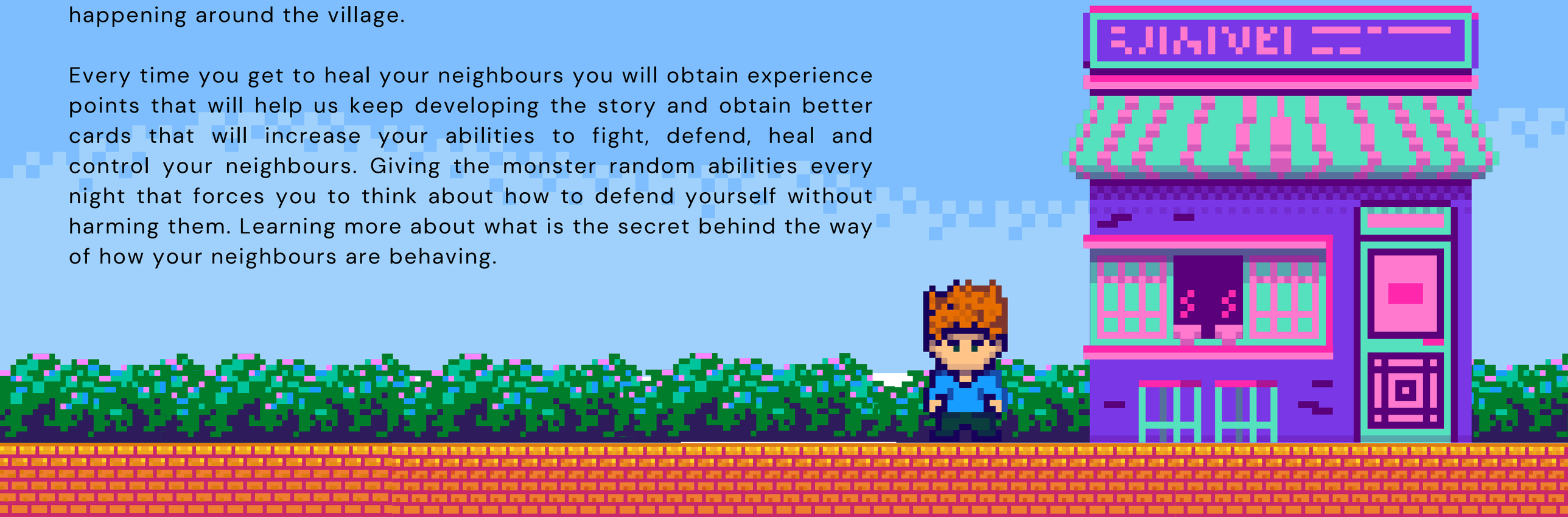
What if the monsters you're fighting... are your neighbors?
Catharsis is a 2D roguelite card game where you play as a little black cat trying to save his village, one cursed neighbor at a time.
Every night they transform. Every run you adapt. Explore their homes, build your deck, and uncover the dark secret behind the curse, without ever hurting your new friends you're trying to protect.
Fight smart. Heal them. Bring them back.



ABOUT GAME

"Catharsis" is a rougelite videogame in 2D where you take the role of a little cat that comes to a new village and discovers his neighbours are behaving quite strange, just to learn that at night they are turning into monsters. He slowly discovers some new cards across the town that will help him protect himself and his new home.
You will randomly explore the different houses of your neighbours, use your cards to save them and protect yourself, and find what is happening around the village.

Every time you get to heal your neighbours you will obtain experience points that will help us keep developing the story and obtain better cards that will increase your abilities to fight, defend, heal and control your neighbours. Giving the monster random abilities every night that forces you to think about how to defend yourself without harming them. Learning more about what is the secret behind the way of how your neighbours are behaving.



ELEMENTS

TRADING CARD GAME:

- **Dynamic Combat System:** A diverse deck featuring attack, defense, crowd control and healing cards.
- **Exploration Based Discovery:** Multiple cards hidden across the map to reward exploration.
- **Victory Loot:** Earn new or duplicate cards as rewards for every successful encounter.
- **Fusion System:** Combine duplicate cards to level up their stats and unlock better abilities.
- **Energy Management:** Every card consumes energy that regenerates every turn, preventing spam and forcing players to manage their resources every encounter.

ROGUELITE:

- **Random Generation:** Randomised map and encounters ensuring no two runs are the same.
- **Death and Recovery:** Upon death the player is stripped of all cards except for 3 random ones, incentivizing exploration and aggressive combat to rebuild.
- **Boss Encounters:** Defeat unique area bosses to unlock new regions and card upgrades.
- **NPCs Unlocks:** Defeating enemies rescues NPCs across the map who provide resources or lore insights.
- **Persistent Status:** Health and energy don't reset after combat. Every combat starts with the remaining stats from the previous encounter.

HOW TO PLAY THIS GAME?

Catharsis is divided into two phases that alternate throughout each run: Day and Night. Every run is unique, with randomized card locations, neighbor encounters and monster abilities that force the player to constantly adapt.

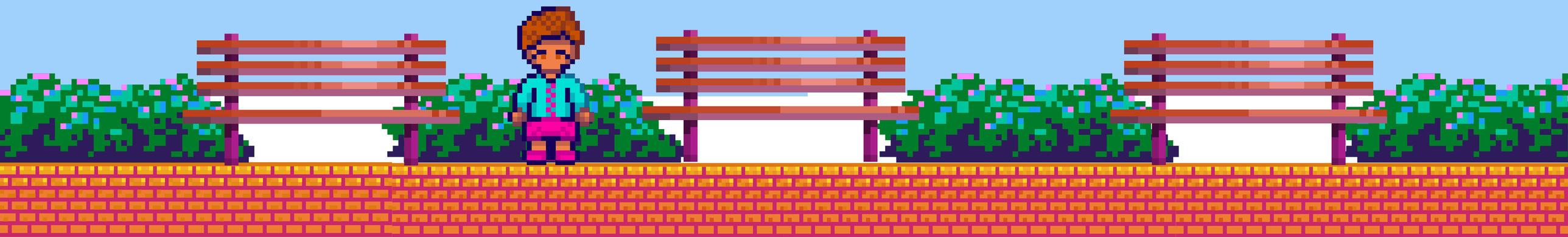
During the Day Phase, the player freely explores the village streets. Cards are scattered randomly across the town and must be found through exploration, as the player starts each run with a completely empty hand. This is the time to prepare, discover and build a strategy before darkness falls.

When Night arrives, neighbors transform into monsters with randomized abilities. Each run features 3 neighbors: two of them must be cured 3 times each before they are fully saved, while the third acts as the final boss, a tougher and more unpredictable encounter that puts everything the player has learned to the test. The objective is always to neutralize the monster without killing them, remembering there is a neighbor underneath. Each card has an energy cost, and the player recovers energy periodically throughout combat, forcing them to think carefully about when and how to play each card. Successfully curing a neighbor rewards the player with new cards, and cards can be combined together to upgrade them into more powerful versions. However, if the player fails while trying to cure a neighbor, they lose most of their deck and are left with only 2 or 3 random cards, forcing them to rebuild and rethink their strategy from scratch. Cards belong to one of four categories: Attack, Defense, Crowd Control and Healing. Managing energy wisely and combining cards effectively is the key to surviving each night and uncovering the secret behind the curse.

VISUAL STYLE

1. The game is designed in 2D, allowing for fluid, straightforward character movement without the need for complex animations. This keeps the focus on strategy and exploration while making development more manageable.

2. The main style will be pixel art, with a dark but cozy aesthetic, think warm candlelit interiors contrasting witch the shadowy nights. The village feels alive during the day and threatening after dark, and that tension lives in every sprite and animation.



CHARACTER

Rotoplas

Us
(your character)

little Jimmy

CHARACTER

CHARACTER

STADISTICS

The game will store player data to track progression and behavior patterns across runs. The key metrics recorded will be:

- Number of times each card is played per run
- Most and least used cards globally
- Number of successful and failed cure attempts
- Average run duration
- Total number of runs played
- Furthest point reached per run
- Cards collected and upgraded over time

THANK
YOU